SWIM

Week 03 Swim

Week 3 of 52 | Mon 19 Oct 2026 to Sun 25 Oct 2026 | Month 1: Breathing, rhythm and the first longer efforts

Tuesday, 20 Oct Swim A - Breathing and rhythm (50 min)

Focus: Calm exhale, symmetrical stroke

Section	Details
Warm-up	200 easy FS, 100 kick with board
Drills	4 x 50 3-3-3 breathing r20 4 x 50 (25 Zipper / 25 FS) r20 4 x 50 6-3-6 r20
Main set	4 x 200 FS steady r40 at training pace. Breathe every 3rd stroke on the odd 200s, every 2nd on the even 200s.
Cool-down	100 easy

Total: about 1800 m
Notes: If bilateral breathing feels air-starved, breathe every 2 strokes and alternate sides each length instead.

Friday, 23 Oct Swim B - Endurance with drill reminders (50 min)

Focus: Holding form as the distance grows

Section	Details
Warm-up	200 easy FS, 4 x 50 Build r20
Main set	4 x (100 drill of your choice from this month + 200 FS steady) r30 after the drill, r40 after the swim. Pick the drill that fixes your weakest link.
Kick	4 x 50 Kick with board r20
Cool-down	100 easy

Total: about 2000 m
Notes: Longest swim of the month. Note how the last 200 felt compared with the first.

Drill cue cards for this week

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
3-3-3 breathing	25 m breathing to the left every stroke, 25 m to the right, 25 m bilateral (every 3rd stroke), then repeat. Exhale continuously through nose and mouth while the face is in the water. Purpose: symmetrical stroke and calm breathing for open water.
Zipper	During recovery, drag the thumb up the side of the body from hip to armpit before reaching forward. Purpose: high elbow recovery and body rotation.
6-3-6	Six kicks on one side (as in Kick on side), three full strokes, six kicks on the other side. Keep the hips high and the extended arm still while kicking. Purpose: rotation, balance, and timing the arm switch with the hips.
Build 50	Start the 50 easy and finish it fast, without letting the stroke shorten. Purpose: learning to raise speed by pressing harder on the water, not by spinning the arms.
Catch-up	Both arms start extended. One arm pulls and recovers while the other waits out front; the recovering hand touches the waiting hand before the next stroke starts. Purpose: long stroke, front-quadrant timing, patience in the glide.

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Fist drill	Swim freestyle with closed fists. You will feel the forearm doing the work. After 25 m of fists open the hands and notice the extra grip. Purpose: early vertical forearm and feel for the water.
Single-arm	One arm swims, the other stays extended in front. Breathe to the side of the working arm. Focus on the catch: fingertips down, elbow high, press back not down. Switch arms every 25. Purpose: catch mechanics and rotation.
Kick with board	Board held at arm's length, face in the water, exhale, breathe forward or to the side. Kick comes from the hips with a soft knee, toes pointed, ankles loose. Small and fast beats big and slow. Purpose: leg endurance and ankle flexibility.